

Security+ CerMaster Study Objective Mapping



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Objective Mapping

	Exam Objective	Lesson Index
1.0	General Security Concepts	
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2.5	Explain the purpose of mitigation techniques used to secure the enterprise	5.3.1 10.1.1, 10.1.2, 10.1.4, 10.1.5
3.0	Security Architecture	

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4.5	Given a scenario, modify enterprise capabilities to enhance security	9.1.4, 9.1.5, 9.2.1, 9.2.2, 9.2.4 10.1.1, 10.1.2, 10.2.1 11.1.1, 11.1.4, 11.1.5, 11.1.6, 11.2.1
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5.0	Security Program Management and Oversight	

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5.3	Explain the processes associated with third-party risk assessment and management	15.2.1, 15.2.2
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5.6	Given a scenario, implement security awareness practices	10.2.1 16.2.2, 16.2.3, 16.2.4

Detailed Objective Mapping

1.0 General Security Concepts

1.1 Compare and contrast various types of security controls

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Security Controls > Categories	1.2.1 Security Control Categories 1.2.2 Security Control Functional Types 1.2.3 Information Security Roles and Responsibilities 1.2.5 Information Security Business Units
Security Controls > Control types	1.2.2 Security Control Functional Types 1.2.4 Information Security Competencies

1.2 Summarize fundamental security concepts

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Confidentiality, Integrity, and Availability (CIA)	1.1.1 Information Security 1.1.2 Cybersecurity Framework 6.2.1 Embedded Systems 7.3.2 Site Layout, Fencing, and Lighting 7.3.3 Gateways and Locks
Non-repudiation	1.1.2 Cybersecurity Framework
Authentication, Authorization, and Accounting (AAA)	1.1.1 Information Security 1.1.2 Cybersecurity Framework
Gap analysis	1.1.4 Access Control
Zero Trust	1.1.4 Access Control 6.2.2 Industrial Control Systems 6.2.5 Zero Trust Security Concepts

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Physical security	7.3.1 Physical Security Controls 7.3.4 Security Guards and Cameras 7.3.5 Alarm Systems and Sensors
Deception and disruption technology	

1.3 Explain the importance of change management processes and the impact to security

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Change Management Processes > Business processes impacting security operation	14.2.1 Change Management Programs 14.2.3 Restarts, Dependencies, and Downtime 14.2.4 Documentation and Version Control
Change Management Processes > Technical implications	14.2.1 Change Management Programs
Change Management Processes > Documentation	14.2.1 Change Management Programs 14.2.2 Allowed and Blocked Changes
Change Management Processes > Documentation > Updating policies/procedures	14.2.3 Restarts, Dependencies, and Downtime
Change Management Processes > Documentation > Version control	

1.4 Explain the importance of using appropriate cryptographic solutions

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Cryptographic Solutions > Public key infrastructure (PKI)	3.1.2 Symmetric Encryption 3.2.1 Certificate Authorities
Cryptographic Solutions > Encryption	3.1.2 Symmetric Encryption 3.1.4 Asymmetric Encryption 3.1.5 Hashing 3.1.6 Digital Signatures 3.3.2 Disk and File Encryption 3.3.3 Database Encryption 3.3.5 Perfect Forward Secrecy 3.3.6 Salting and Key Stretching 3.3.8 Obfuscation
Cryptographic Solutions > Tools	3.2.8 Cryptoprocessors and Secure Enclaves
Cryptographic Solutions > Obfuscation	3.3.7 Blockchain
Cryptographic Solutions > Hashing	3.1.5 Hashing 3.3.5 Perfect Forward Secrecy
Cryptographic Solutions > Salting	3.3.6 Salting and Key Stretching
Cryptographic Solutions > Key stretching	
Cryptographic Solutions > Certificates	3.2.2 Digital Certificates 3.2.3 Root of Trust 3.2.6 Certificate Revocation 3.2.7 Key Management 3.2.9 Key Escrow

2.0 Threats, Vulnerabilities, and Mitigations

2.1 Compare and contrast common threat actors and motivations

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Threat Actors > Threat actors	2.1.1 Vulnerability, Threat, and Risk 2.1.2 Attributes of Threat Actors 2.1.3 Motivations of Threat Actors 2.1.4 Hackers and Hacktivists 2.1.5 Nation-State Actors
Threat Actors > Attributes of actors	2.1.4 Hackers and Hacktivists 2.1.7 Internal Threat Actors
Threat Actors > Motivations	2.1.2 Attributes of Threat Actors 2.1.5 Nation-State Actors 2.1.6 Organized Crime and Competitors

2.2 Explain common threat vectors and attack surfaces

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Vectors and Attack Surfaces > Message-based	2.2.3 Network Vectors
Vectors and Attack Surfaces > Image-based	
Vectors and Attack Surfaces > Removable device	
Vectors and Attack Surfaces > Vulnerable software	2.2.2 Vulnerable Software Vectors 2.2.4 Lure-Based Vectors 2.2.5 Message-Based Vectors
Vectors and Attack Surfaces > Vulnerable software > Unsupported systems and applications	2.2.1 Attack Surface and Threat Vectors 2.2.3 Network Vectors
Vectors and Attack Surfaces > Unsecure networks	2.2.4 Lure-Based Vectors 11.1.3 Secure Directory Services
Vectors and Attack Surfaces > Default credentials	
Vectors and Attack Surfaces > Supply chain	2.2.6 Supply Chain Attack Surface 2.3.2 Impersonation and Pretexting
Vectors and Attack Surfaces > Human vectors/ social engineering	2.2.1 Attack Surface and Threat Vectors 2.3.1 Human Vectors 2.3.3 Phishing and Pharming 2.3.4 Typosquatting 2.3.5 Business Email Compromise

2.3 Explain various types of vulnerabilities

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Application	8.1.1 Operating System Vulnerabilities 8.1.2 Vulnerability Types 8.1.6 Sideloading, Rooting, and Jailbreaking 8.2.1 Application Vulnerabilities

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Web-based	8.2.1 Application Vulnerabilities
Hardware	8.1.2 Vulnerability Types 8.1.5 Cryptographic Vulnerabilities 8.2.4 Cloud-based Application Attacks
Virtualization	
Supply chain	8.2.3 Web Application Attacks
Cryptographic	8.2.3 Web Application Attacks
Misconfiguration	8.1.6 Sideloading, Rooting, and Jailbreaking
Mobile device	8.1.4 Misconfiguration Vulnerabilities
Zero-day	8.1.2 Vulnerability Types 8.1.3 Zero-Day Vulnerabilities

2.4 Given a scenario, analyze indicators of malicious activity

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Malicious Activity > Malware attacks	13.1.1 Malware Classification 13.1.2 Computer Viruses 13.1.3 Computer Worms and Fileless Malware 13.1.5 Backdoors and Remote Access Trojans 13.1.6 Rootkits 13.1.7 Ransomware, Crypto-Malware, and Logic Bombs 13.1.8 TTPs and IoCs 13.1.9 Malicious Activity Indicators
Malicious Activity > Physical attacks	13.2.1 Physical Attacks
Malicious Activity > Network attacks	13.1.9 Malicious Activity Indicators 13.2.3 Distributed Denial of Service Attacks 13.2.4 On-Path Attacks 13.2.6 Wireless Attacks 13.2.7 Password Attacks 13.3.1 Application Attacks
Malicious Activity > Application attacks	13.3.1 Application Attacks 13.3.3 Forgery Attacks 13.3.4 Injection Attacks 13.3.6 URL Analysis 13.3.7 Web Server Logs
Malicious Activity > Cryptographic attacks	
Malicious Activity > Password attacks	13.2.2 Network Attacks
Malicious Activity > Indicators	13.1.4 Spyware and Keyloggers 13.2.5 Domain Name System Attacks 13.3.2 Replay Attacks

2.5 Explain the purpose of mitigation techniques used to secure the enterprise

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Mitigation Techniques > Segmentation	
Mitigation Techniques > Access control	10.1.2 Endpoint Protection

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Mitigation Techniques > Application allow list	
Mitigation Techniques > Patching	
Mitigation Techniques > Least privilege	5.3.1 Remote Access Architecture 10.1.2 Endpoint Protection
Mitigation Techniques > Configuration enforcement	10.1.1 Endpoint Hardening
Mitigation Techniques > Decommissioning	
Mitigation Techniques > Hardening techniques	10.1.1 Endpoint Hardening 10.1.2 Endpoint Protection 10.1.4 Endpoint Configuration 10.1.5 Hardening Techniques

3.0 Security Architecture

3.1 Compare and contrast security implications of different architecture models

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Architecture Models > Architecture and infrastructure concepts	5.1.1 Architecture and Infrastructure Concepts 5.1.4 Routing Infrastructure Considerations 5.1.5 Security Zones 5.1.6 Attack Surface 5.2.3 Firewalls 6.1.1 Cloud Deployment Models 6.1.2 Cloud Service Models 6.1.3 Responsibility Matrix 6.1.5 Resilient Architecture Concepts 6.1.8 Cloud Automation Technologies 6.1.9 Software Defined Networking 6.1.11 Cloud Security Considerations 6.2.3 Internet of Things 6.2.4 Deperimeterization and Zero Trust
Architecture Models > Considerations	5.1.1 Architecture and Infrastructure Concepts 5.1.2 Network Infrastructure 5.1.3 Switching Infrastructure Considerations 5.1.4 Routing Infrastructure Considerations 5.1.7 Port Security

3.2 Given a scenario, apply security principles to secure enterprise infrastructure

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Security Enterprise Infrastructure > Infrastructure considerations	5.1.7 Port Security 5.2.1 Device Placement 5.2.2 Device Attributes 5.2.5 Proxy Servers 5.2.6 Intrusion Detection Systems 5.2.9 Web Application Firewalls 5.3.1 Remote Access Architecture 5.3.3 Internet Protocol Security Tunneling

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Security Enterprise Infrastructure > Infrastructure considerations > Secure communication/access	5.2.7 Next-Generation Firewalls and Unified Threat Management 5.2.8 Load Balancers 5.3.2 Transport Layer Security Tunneling 5.3.5 Remote Desktop 5.3.6 Secure Shell

3.3 Compare and contrast concepts and strategies to protect data

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Data Protection > Data types	16.1.1 Data Types 16.1.2 Data Classifications
Data Protection > Data classifications	
Data Protection > General data considerations	3.3.1 Encryption Supporting Confidentiality 16.1.1 Data Types
Data Protection > Methods to secure data	16.1.3 Data Sovereignty and Geographical Considerations

3.4 Explain the importance of resilience and recovery in security architecture

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Security Architecture > High availability	7.2.8 Testing Resiliency
Security Architecture > Site considerations	
Security Architecture > Multi-cloud systems	
Security Architecture > Continuity of operations	7.2.3 High Availability 7.3.2 Site Layout, Fencing, and Lighting
Security Architecture > Capacity planning	
Security Architecture > Continuity of operations > Testing	
Security Architecture > Backups	7.1.4 Advanced Data Protection 7.2.1 Continuity of Operations
Security Architecture > Power	7.1.1 Asset Tracking 7.2.1 Continuity of Operations 7.2.3 High Availability

4.0 Security Operations

4.1 Given a scenario, apply common security techniques to computing resources

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Computing Resources > Secure baselines	9.1.1 Benchmarks and Secure Configuration Guides 9.1.2 Wireless Network Installation Considerations 9.1.3 Wireless Encryption

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Computing Resources > Hardening targets	9.1.1 Benchmarks and Secure Configuration Guides 10.2.2 Full Device Encryption and External Media 11.2.1 Secure Coding Techniques
Computing Resources > Wireless devices	
Computing Resources > Mobile solutions	9.1.1 Benchmarks and Secure Configuration Guides 10.2.5 Wi-Fi and Tethering Connection Methods 10.2.6 Bluetooth Connection Methods
Computing Resources > Wireless security settings	3.3.4 Transport Encryption and Key Exchange 9.1.1 Benchmarks and Secure Configuration Guides 9.1.4 Wi-Fi Authentication Methods
Computing Resources > Application security	11.2.2 Application Protections
Computing Resources > Sandboxing	10.1.3 Advanced Endpoint Protection

4.2 Explain the security implications of proper hardware, software, and data asset management

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Asset Management > Acquisition/procurement process	
Asset Management > Assignment/accounting	7.1.5 Secure Data Destruction
Asset Management > Monitoring/asset tracking	7.1.1 Asset Tracking 7.1.3 Data Backups
Asset Management > Disposal/decommissioning	7.1.2 Asset Protection Concepts 7.1.4 Advanced Data Protection 7.1.5 Secure Data Destruction

4.3 Explain various activities associated with vulnerability management

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Vulnerability Management > Identification methods	8.2.1 Application Vulnerabilities 8.3.1 Vulnerability Scanning 8.3.2 Threat Feeds 8.4.1 Common Vulnerabilities and Exposures 8.4.2 False Positives, False Negatives, and Log Review 8.4.3 Vulnerability Analysis 8.4.4 Vulnerability Response and Remediation
Vulnerability Management > Analysis	8.3.1 Vulnerability Scanning 8.3.3 Deep and Dark Web 8.3.4 Other Vulnerability Assessment Methods 8.4.4 Vulnerability Response and Remediation
Vulnerability Management > Vulnerability response and remediation	8.3.1 Vulnerability Scanning 8.3.2 Threat Feeds 10.2.3 Location Services

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Vulnerability Management > Validation of remediation	

4.4 Explain security alerting and monitoring concepts and tools

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Security Alerts and Monitoring > Monitoring computing resources	12.4.4 Monitoring Infrastructure
Security Alerts and Monitoring > Activities	12.4.2 Alerting and Monitoring Activities 12.4.3 Alert Tuning
Security Alerts and Monitoring > Tools	8.3.1 Vulnerability Scanning 11.1.2 Transport Layer Security 12.4.1 Security Information and Event Management 12.4.2 Alerting and Monitoring Activities 12.4.4 Monitoring Infrastructure

4.5 Given a scenario, modify enterprise capabilities to enhance security

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Enterprise Capabilities > Firewall	
Enterprise Capabilities > IDS/IPS	9.1.5 Network Access Control 9.2.2 Intrusion Detection and Prevention Systems 10.2.1 Mobile Hardening Techniques
Enterprise Capabilities > Web filter	10.2.1 Mobile Hardening Techniques
Enterprise Capabilities > Operating system security	10.1.2 Endpoint Protection
Enterprise Capabilities > Implementation of secure protocols	9.1.4 Wi-Fi Authentication Methods 9.2.1 Access Control Lists 9.2.2 Intrusion Detection and Prevention Systems 9.2.4 Web Filtering 11.1.1 Secure Protocols 11.1.4 Simple Network Management Protocol Security 11.1.5 File Transfer Services 11.1.6 Email Services 11.2.1 Secure Coding Techniques
Enterprise Capabilities > Email security	
Enterprise Capabilities > File integrity monitoring	9.2.2 Intrusion Detection and Prevention Systems
Enterprise Capabilities > Network access control (NAC)	
Enterprise Capabilities > Endpoint detection and response (EDR)/extended detection and response (XDR)	

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Enterprise Capabilities > User behavior analytics	9.2.2 Intrusion Detection and Prevention Systems 10.1.1 Endpoint Hardening

4.6 Given a scenario, implement and maintain identity and access management

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Access Management > Provisioning/de-provisioning user accounts	4.2.6 Account Attributes and Access Policies
Access Management > Permission assignments and implications	4.2.7 Account Restrictions
Access Management > Federation	4.3.5 Federation
Access Management > Single sign-on (SSO)	4.3.1 Local, Network, and Remote Authentication 4.3.3 Single Sign-on Authentication 4.3.6 Security Assertion Markup Language
Access Management > Access controls	4.2.1 Discretionary and Mandatory Access Control 4.2.2 Role- and Attribute-Based Access Control 4.2.4 Least Privilege Permission Assignments 4.2.5 User Account Provisioning 4.2.8 Privileged Access Management 4.3.2 Directory Services 6.2.5 Zero Trust Security Concepts 7.3.3 Gateways and Locks
Access Management > Multifactor authentication	4.1.3 Password Managers 4.1.6 Hard Authentication Tokens 4.1.7 Soft Authentication Tokens 4.1.8 Passwordless Authentication 11.1.1 Secure Protocols
Access Management > Password concepts	4.1.1 Authentication Design 4.1.2 Password Concepts 4.1.4 Multifactor Authentication 4.1.5 Biometric Authentication
Access Management > Privileged access management tools	

4.7 Explain the importance of automation and orchestration related to secure operations

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Secure Operations > Use cases of automation and scripting	4.3.1 Local, Network, and Remote Authentication 14.3.1 Automation and Scripting 14.3.2 Automation and Orchestration Implementation
Secure Operations > Benefits	14.3.1 Automation and Scripting
Secure Operations > Other considerations	14.3.1 Automation and Scripting

4.8 Explain appropriate incident response activities

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Incident Response Activities > Process	7.2.1 Continuity of Operations 12.1.2 Preparation 12.1.4 Analysis 12.1.5 Containment 12.1.6 Eradication and Recovery 12.1.7 Lessons Learned 12.1.8 Testing and Training 12.1.9 Threat Hunting 12.2.1 Due Process and Legal Hold 12.2.2 Acquisition 12.2.3 System Memory Acquisition 12.2.4 Disk Image Acquisition 12.2.5 Preservation 15.1.4 Business Impact Analysis
Incident Response Activities > Training	
Incident Response Activities > Testing	
Incident Response Activities > Root cause analysis	
Incident Response Activities > Threat hunting	12.1.3 Detection 12.1.6 Eradication and Recovery 12.2.1 Due Process and Legal Hold
Incident Response Activities > Digital forensics	

4.9 Given a scenario, use data sources to support an investigation

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Support an Investigation > Log data	12.3.1 Data Sources, Dashboards, and Reports 12.3.2 Log Data 12.3.3 Host Operating System Logs 12.3.4 Application and Endpoint Logs 12.3.5 Network Data Sources 12.3.6 Packet Captures 12.3.7 Metadata
Support an Investigation > Data sources	

5.0 Security Program Management and Oversight

5.1 Summarize elements of effective security governance

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Security Governance > Guidelines	14.1.1 Policies 16.2.1 Conduct Policies
Security Governance > Policies	7.2.3 High Availability 14.1.1 Policies 14.1.5 Governance and Accountability 16.2.1 Conduct Policies
Security Governance > Standards	14.1.2 Procedures 14.1.5 Governance and Accountability

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Security Governance > Guidelines > Procedures	14.1.3 Standards 14.1.5 Governance and Accountability
Security Governance > Monitoring and revision	
Security Governance > Types of governance structures	14.1.3 Standards 14.1.4 Legal Environment 14.1.5 Governance and Accountability
Security Governance > Roles and responsibilities for systems and data	14.1.5 Governance and Accountability

5.2 Explain elements of the risk management process

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Risk Management > Risk identification	16.2.4 Security Awareness Training Lifecycle
Risk Management > Risk assessment	15.1.1 Risk Identification and Assessment 15.1.2 Risk Management Strategies
Risk Management > Risk analysis	15.1.2 Risk Management Strategies 15.1.3 Risk Management Processes
Risk Management > Risk register	15.1.1 Risk Identification and Assessment 15.1.3 Risk Management Processes
Risk Management > Risk tolerance	
Risk Management > Risk appetite	
Risk Management > Risk management strategies	15.1.3 Risk Management Processes
Risk Management > Business impact analysis	15.1.1 Risk Identification and Assessment 15.1.4 Business Impact Analysis

5.3 Explain the processes associated with third-party risk assessment and management

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Risk Assessment and Management > Vendor assessment	15.2.1 Vendor Selection 15.2.2 Vendor Assessment Methods
Risk Assessment and Management > Vendor selection	
Risk Assessment and Management > Agreement types	15.2.1 Vendor Selection 15.2.2 Vendor Assessment Methods
Risk Assessment and Management > Questionnaires	
Risk Assessment and Management > Rules of engagement	

5.4 Summarize elements of effective security compliance

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Security Compliance > Compliance reporting	16.1.9 Data Loss Prevention
Security Compliance > Consequences of non-compliance	16.1.7 Monitoring and Reporting
Security Compliance > Compliance monitoring	16.1.8 Data Protection
Security Compliance > Privacy	16.1.4 Privacy Data 16.1.5 Privacy Breaches and Data Breaches 16.1.6 Compliance

5.5 Explain types and purposes of audits and assessments

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Audits and Assessments > Attestation	
Audits and Assessments > Internal	15.3.1 Attestation and Assessments
Audits and Assessments > External	15.3.1 Attestation and Assessments 15.3.2 Penetration Testing
Audits and Assessments > Penetration testing	15.3.1 Attestation and Assessments 15.3.2 Penetration Testing

5.6 Given a scenario, implement security awareness practices

Exam Objective	Course Resource
Security Awareness > Phishing	16.2.3 Training Topics and Techniques
Security Awareness > Anomalous behavior recognition	10.2.1 Mobile Hardening Techniques
Security Awareness > User guidance and training	16.2.2 User and Role-Based Training 16.2.3 Training Topics and Techniques 16.2.4 Security Awareness Training Lifecycle
Security Awareness > Reporting and monitoring	16.2.3 Training Topics and Techniques
Security Awareness > Development	
Security Awareness > Execution	16.2.4 Security Awareness Training Lifecycle